

ADRIAN CIOANCA

PhD | Data & AI Consultant | Biotech Co-founder | NV1 Security Clearance

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PROFILE

Data scientist with statistical modelling depth, four years leading research teams, and consulting delivery in data and AI for energy, Defence, and public health clients. Take problems from definition through to a signed-off result, and build the teams that deliver them. Applying for the Associate role to move from building data and AI solutions to framing the strategy questions behind them, across pharmaceuticals, financial services, and the public sector.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Accenture | Strategy & Consulting, Data & AI | Consultant / Team Lead **2025 - Present**

- Took ownership of data engineering on a Defence digital transformation, building the workflow from ingestion to insights presentation in an air-gapped environment and leading 3 analysts with assigned roles and coaching to lift capability; client approved the workflow and commissioned the next build phase.
- Designed the retrieval layer of a regulatory intelligence application for a national energy retailer whose compliance team tracked legislative change by hand over days, scoping requirements with them and building hybrid vector and BM25 search on Azure; review fell to minutes at over 99% accuracy, surfacing clauses previously missed.
- Built an internal Defence market intelligence platform (React, FastAPI, AI agents over AusTender, ministerial releases, and competitor activity) after finding bid teams had no shared market view; opportunity research fell from hours to minutes and now feeds the market sizing used on live bids.
- Ran community engagement for the Canberra office alongside client delivery as Data & AI social lead, founder of the office soccer team, and representative at graduate recruitment fairs; earned formal recognition from 3 Managing Directors for delivery and community contribution.

ErythroSight | Co-founder & CTO · **Tractum Bio Consulting** | Founder **2023 - Present**

- Co-founded an ANU spin-off with three researchers to commercialise blood-derived retinal therapeutics, setting the scientific strategy, selecting the lead candidate, and running CRO, IP, and regulatory partners through IND-enabling planning; secured 3 national patents and exited via commercial licensing.
- Built the valuation and market case for a preclinical asset (DCF, rNPV, prevalence and pricing), co-wrote the investor materials, and pitched at 3 national accelerators, raising \$670K non-dilutive and winning a place in CSIRO ON Accelerate (under 5% acceptance).
- Founded Tractum Bio Consulting in 2025 to sell the same capability as a service, winning contracts with Merck and GenN Tech for AI-enabled ophthalmic development models and automated CRO data pipelines.

Australian National University | Postdoctoral Researcher, John Curtin School of Medical Research **2022 - 2026**

- Led a 7-person team on RNA therapeutics for retinal degeneration across 20 groups at 7 universities, taking my record to 25 papers (9 as lead author, 3rd most published in the field nationally, 2024), winning \$514K in competitive funding, and earning promotion to Level B in 1.5 years against a 4 to 5 year norm.
- Delivered a \$200K end-to-end preclinical model for Merck & Co., which was outsourcing ophthalmic discovery and losing 3 months per cycle, running prototyping, fabrication, and client training; time to results fell to 2 weeks, the work moved in-house, and the build returned 8x its cost.
- Designed analytics pipelines for 4 biotech partners, finding a new indication for VivaZome's lead therapeutic and resetting its ophthalmology roadmap to support a \$3M CRC-P raise; work for MDImune secured joint IP in South Korea and lifted lead-product efficacy 20%.

EDUCATION

Australian National University | PhD, Neuroscience & Bioinformatics **2018 - 2022**

- Won the Frank Fenner Medal for the best PhD at the John Curtin School of Medical Research (sole recipient, cohort of 103) and was nominated for the J.G. Crawford Prize for best thesis at ANU (1 of 2 university-wide).
- Held the Australian Postgraduate Award (\$112K, top 5%), won 4 competitive grants (\$97K, 5 to 10% success rates), and was elected ANU representative to the Global Young Scientists Summit.

University of New South Wales | BSc Advanced Science, First Class Honours **2013 - 2017**

- Graduated with the top honours mark in the cohort and won 2 research scholarships awarded to the top 10% of the faculty.

SKILLS, LEADERSHIP & INTERESTS

Technical: Python (scikit-learn, XGBoost, TensorFlow), R (expert), SQL, Azure and GCP, PostgreSQL with pgvector, embeddings and vector retrieval, GLM/GAM and empirical Bayes modelling.

Commercial: DCF and rNPV valuation, market sizing, competitor analysis, IP strategy, investor pitch development. Continuing study: Harvard Stats 110, MIT 18.06.

Leadership and interests: Founded Vision ACTion, a forum for retinal researchers, clinicians, and patients. Sole genetics lecturer, ANU Medical School (4.8/5, 87 evaluations). Placed 2nd of 10 at the InnovFest Singapore hackathon, pitching to Westpac and Singtel. Chess team captain; 4th, NSW Mathematics Olympiad. Live interview, Sky News Australia.